

Instant Vlog Clip

A mobile-first web app that turns a pile of phone clips into a short narrated vlog: add clips, write a few lines or let AI write them, pick a voice or record your own, and get a vertical video with captions, a title and music.

Status working prototype, placeholder UI **Platform** web, phone first

Branding to come from the client **Language** English

● THE BRIEF

Design the app around one feeling: “that was too easy.”

The app works end to end today, but every screen uses a plain placeholder look built only to prove the flow. Your job is to give it a real visual identity and polish every screen and state listed below. Layout and flow can change where you see a better way; the steps and the information on each screen are what the product needs.

Who uses it. Casual creators who film a lot on their phones and never edit: travellers, students, small business owners, “day in my life” posters. They post to TikTok, Instagram Reels and YouTube Shorts. They are not editors and should never see a timeline.

What makes it different. The video is cut to a short first-person story (the script), read aloud by an AI voice or by the user. That’s what separates it from “random highlights” apps.

The client will send name, logo and brand colours later.

Design a system where the brand can drop in: keep the brand colour, logo and wordmark in a few clearly named tokens and slots. “Instant Vlog Clip” is the working name.

Principles to design by

- **Instant first, perfect second.** The first result arrives with no decisions. Every option has a good default and can be skipped.

- **The video is the hero.** On the editor, the preview is the biggest thing on screen; everything else supports it.
- **Edit by tapping and talking, not timelines.** Changes happen on scene cards and by typing a request to the AI.
- **“Your videos stay on this device.”** Users’ footage is never uploaded. This is a real promise worth showing where it reassures (home, export, sign-in).
- **Phone first.** Every screen must work one-handed at 390px wide. Desktop is a centred column today and can stay that way.

• WHAT WE NEED FROM YOU

Deliverables

- ☐ **Visual direction:** one or two options for type, colour and overall feel, before detailed screens.
- ☐ **All screens and states** in the inventory, at 390×844 (phone). Desktop for home, script and editor at 1280 wide.
- ☐ **Light and dark** versions. The app follows the phone’s setting.
- ☐ **Component sheet:** buttons, chips, inputs, cards, bottom sheet, progress, toasts, step bar, scene card, clip tile (list in Components).
- ☐ **Design tokens** mapped to the existing token names, or a new list we can swap in.
- ☐ **Caption and title styles for the video:** 4–6 presets with exact specs (see The video itself). These are burned into users’ exported videos, so they matter as much as the app UI.
- ☐ **Motion notes** for the few moments that deserve it: generating progress, scene change, export complete.
- ☐ **App icon and favicon** placeholders (final once branding arrives).

Figma is ideal. Name frames by the screen and state names used here (for example “Voice / Record / Teleprompter recording”) so we can match them to code.

• FLOW

Five steps, always visible

Each vlog moves through five steps shown as a step bar at the top. Users can go back to any step they’ve reached. A typical run takes about three minutes.



Shortcut: on Script, “No script” skips Voice and makes a music-only montage.

Sign-in appears only when a guest has used their free vlog.

● SCREEN INVENTORY

Every screen and state

Screenshots are the current placeholder UI, captured from the working app with test footage (the colour bars are test videos, not real clips). Tap any image to enlarge it.

/

Home

First impression and the list of the user’s vlogs. One clear action: start a new vlog.

CONTENT

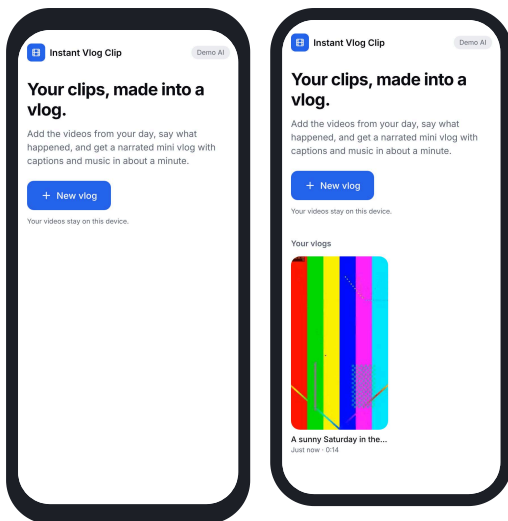
- Product name and a one-line promise
- “New vlog” primary button
- “Your videos stay on this device” reassurance
- Grid of past vlogs: cover frame, title, last edited, length
- Sign in / account (live mode only), “Demo AI” badge in demo mode

STATES

- First visit (no vlogs)
- With vlogs
- Delete vlog (confirm, then remove)

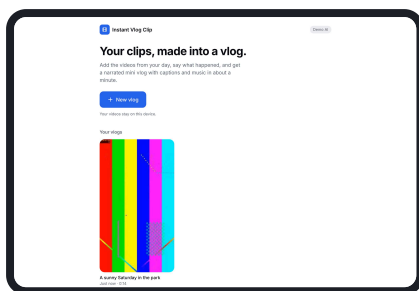
OPEN QUESTIONS FOR YOU

- Should the empty home show an example of an output video to set expectations?
- Desktop: is a centred column right, or a wider gallery?



First visit
No vlogs yet

With vlogs
Cover, title, date,
length



Desktop
1280 wide

/p/:id/clips · step 1

Clips

Pick videos from the phone’s gallery (or drag them in on desktop). Each clip is read on the device; thumbnails appear one by one.

CONTENT

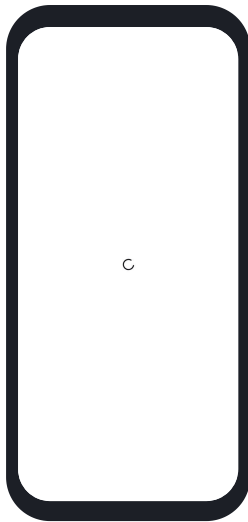
- Heading + one line: “Messy is fine”
- Big “Choose videos” target
- Clip tiles: thumbnail, duration, star (“must include”), remove
- “Similar” badge on near-duplicate clips
- Footer: “6 clips · 0:43 of 10:00 max” + Continue

STATES

- Empty
- Importing (per-tile spinner)
- Ready, one starred
- Tile error: “This browser can’t decode ... video”
- Limits hit: toast (30 clips, 10 min, 4 GB)

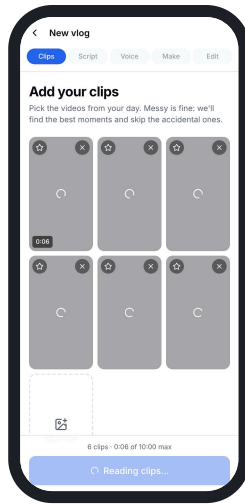
LIMITS & FORMATS

- MP4, MOV, WebM
- Up to 30 clips, 10 minutes, 4 GB
- Vertical or horizontal; horizontal clips get cropped to vertical automatically



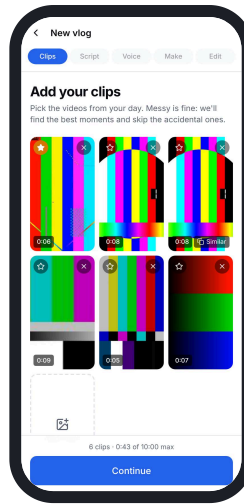
Empty

Choose videos



Importing

Tiles fill in one by one



Ready

First clip starred, one marked Similar

/p/:id/script · step 2

Script

The story, as short first-person lines, one per moment. The user writes them, or taps “Write it for me” and AI writes them from what’s in the clips. Each line becomes a scene and is read aloud.

CONTENT

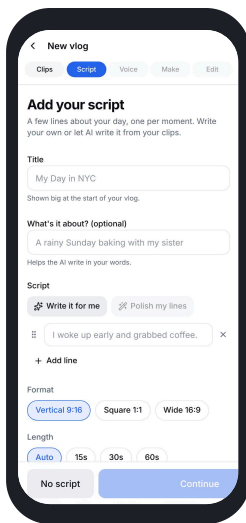
- Title (shown big at the start of the video)
- “What’s it about?” optional prompt
- Line list: drag to reorder, remove, Enter adds a line
- Write it for me / Rewrite with AI · Polish my lines
- “About 0:13 spoken” estimate
- Settings chips: Format, Length, Vibe
- Footer: No script · Continue

STATES

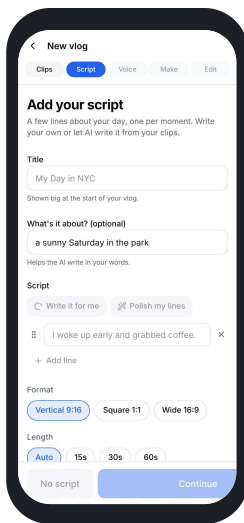
- Empty (one blank line with an example placeholder)
- AI writing (buttons busy)
- Filled
- “Replace your lines?” confirm before rewriting

SETTINGS VALUES

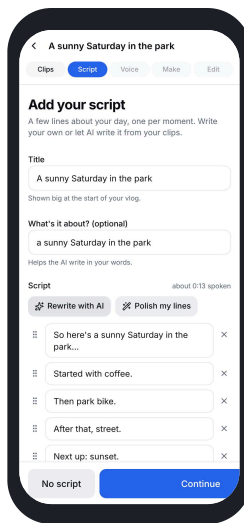
- Format: Vertical 9:16 (default), Square 1:1, Wide 16:9
- Length: Auto (default), 15s, 30s, 60s
- Vibe: Auto, Chill, Upbeat, Cinematic, Funny, Aesthetic



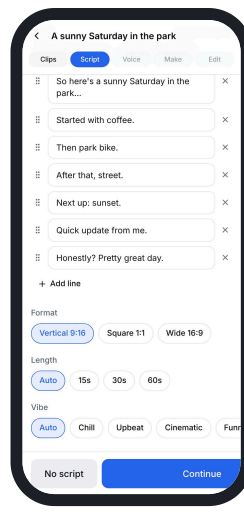
Empty



AI writing

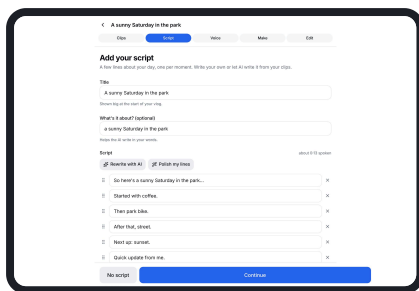


Filled



Settings

Format, length, vibe



Desktop

/p/:id/voice · step 3

Voice

Who tells the story: an AI voice, the user's own voice, or nobody (lines appear as captions only).

AI VOICE

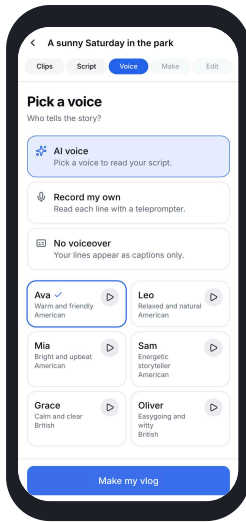
- Six voices: Ava, Leo, Mia, Sam (American), Grace, Oliver (British)
- Each has a one-line description and a play button that reads the user's first line

RECORD MY OWN

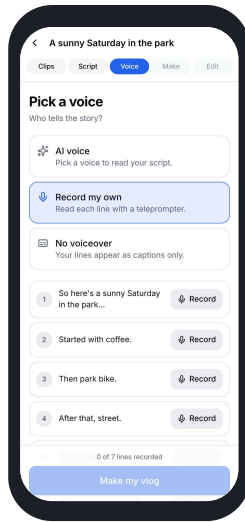
- List of lines with Record / Redo and play
- Teleprompter: one line at a time, big text, a large record button, a live level meter, timer, Previous / Skip
- Auto-advances after each take
- Footer counts "2 of 7 lines recorded"; Continue waits until all are done

STATES

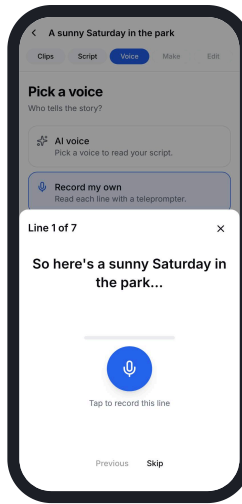
- AI selected, preview loading / playing
- Record list, partly recorded
- Teleprompter idle / recording / saving
- Microphone blocked (toast)
- No voiceover



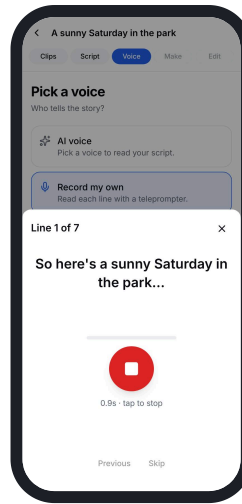
AI voice



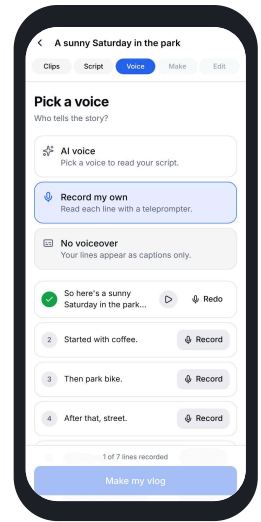
Record my own



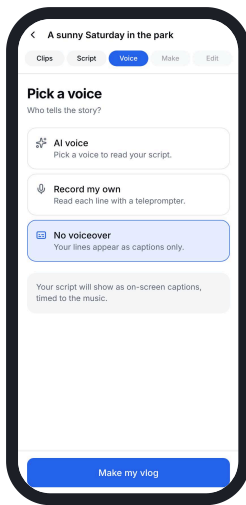
Teleprompter
Ready



Teleprompter
Recording



Partly recorded



No voiceover

/p/:id/generate · step 4

Make

The AI builds the vlog. Usually under a minute. This is the one waiting moment in the product, so it deserves care: honest stages, real progress, and something pleasant to look at.

STAGES (IN ORDER)

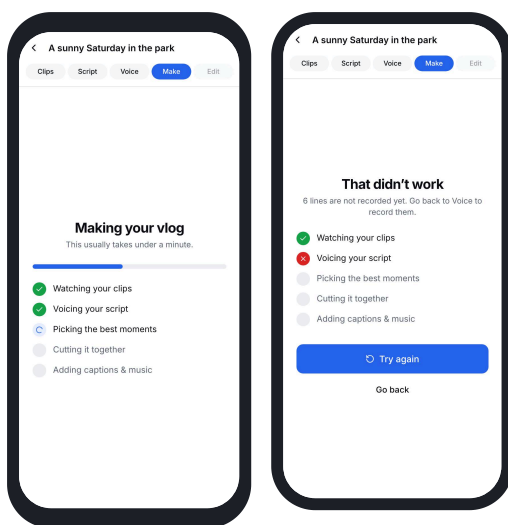
- Watching your clips (shows “3 of 6 clips”)
- Voicing your script (“2 of 7 lines”)
- Picking the best moments
- Cutting it together
- Adding captions & music

IDEA SPACE

- Clip thumbnails or the title animating while it works
- A sign-in prompt can appear here when a guest runs out of free vlogs

STATES

- In progress
- Error: the failed stage is marked, with a plain message, Try again and Go back
- On success it moves straight to Edit



In progress

Error
Lines not recorded

/p/:id/edit • step 5

Edit

The vlog plays right away. Below it are the scenes (one per script line) and three panels for the whole video. At the bottom, users can type a change for the AI (“open with the sunset”). Undo and redo walk through versions.

ALWAYS VISIBLE

- Undo / redo, note about the current version, Export
- Phone-shaped preview with play / scrub / time
- Tabs: Scenes, Voice, Music, Style
- “Tell the AI” input with suggestion chips

SCENE SHEET (TAP A SCENE)

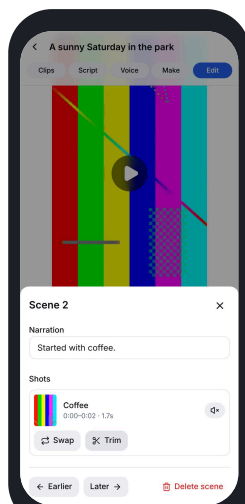
- Edit the narration line (re-voices just that line)
- Each shot: thumbnail, range, clip-sound toggle (off / quiet / full)
- Swap: grid of other good moments
- Trim: start / end sliders
- Move earlier / later, Delete scene

PANELS

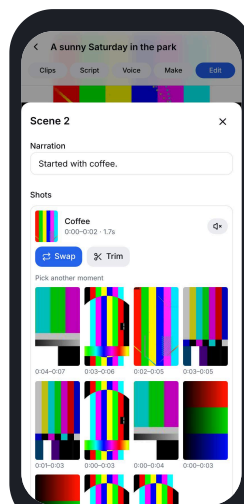
- Voice: switch AI voice, voice volume
- Music: five tracks + No music, volume (music dips under speech automatically)
- Style: title text, caption style presets



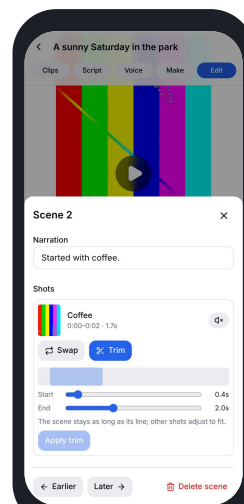
Scenes
Default view



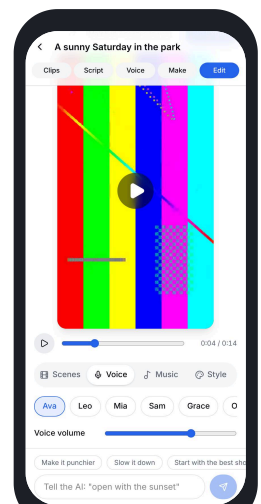
Scene sheet



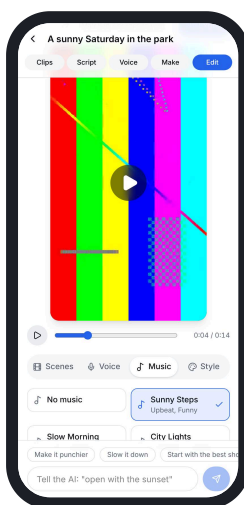
Swap shot



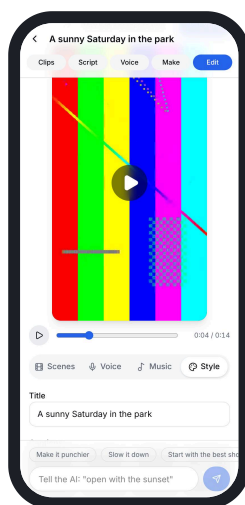
Trim shot



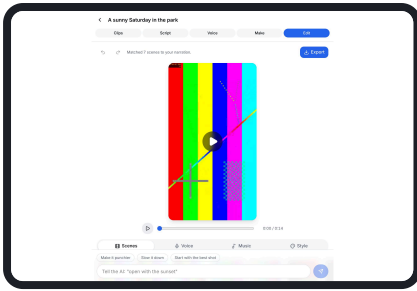
Voice panel



Music panel



Style panel



Desktop

Could use the width: preview left, scenes and panels right

Known weak spots to solve

- On a phone the sticky “Tell the AI” bar and the tabs compete for space. Consider collapsing Tell the AI into a button that opens a sheet.
- The scene sheet covers the preview; users can’t see the change they’re making. A shorter sheet or a mini preview inside it would help.
- Scene cards show the first shot only; a scene can have up to three shots.

Export sheet (from Edit)

Export & share

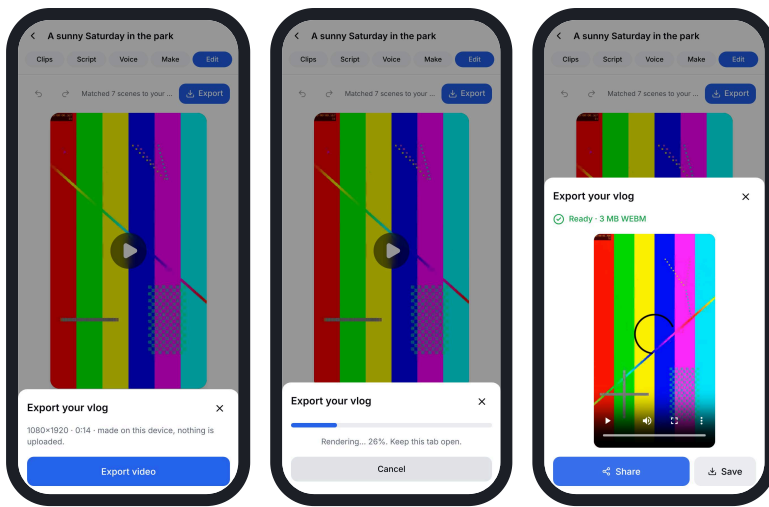
The video is rendered on the phone itself. Then the native share sheet opens (save to Photos, TikTok, Instagram...) or, on desktop, it downloads.

STATES

- Ready: size, length, “made on this device, nothing is uploaded”
- Rendering: progress %, “Keep this tab open”, Cancel
- Done: playable result, file size, Share, Save
- Error: message + Try again

FACTS

- 1080×1920 for vertical, 30 fps, MP4 (WebM on some browsers)
- A 30 s vlog takes roughly 20–40 s to render



Ready

Rendering

Done

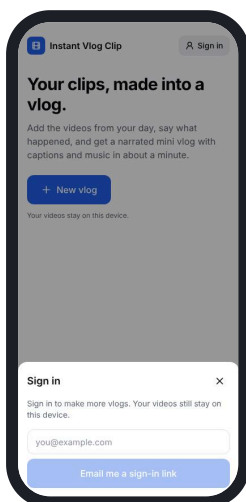
Sign-in sheet (any screen)

Sign in

Guests get one free vlog. After that, or when a daily limit is hit, this sheet explains why and offers an email sign-in link (Google sign-in can be switched on).

STATES

- Enter email
- Sending
- “Check your email for a sign-in link”
- Error
- Signed in: email + sign out on Home

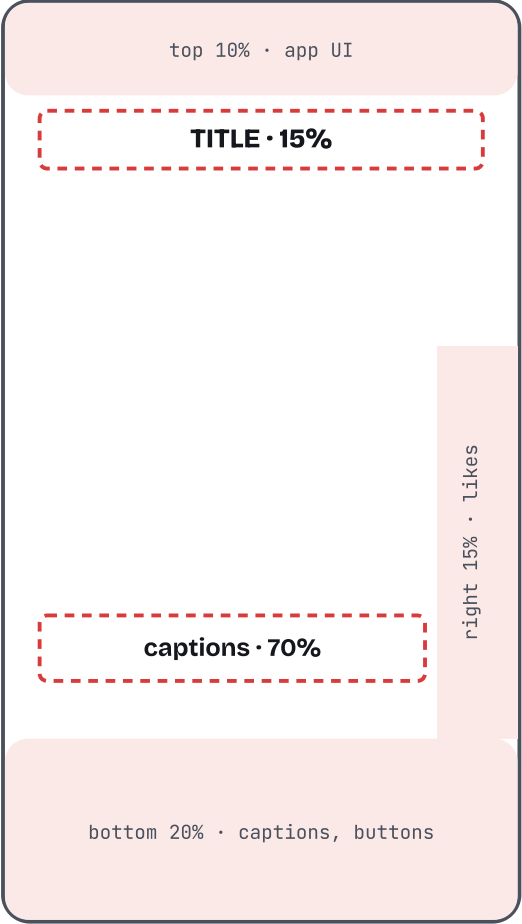


Sign in

● THE VIDEO ITSELF

Titles and captions are part of your design

Every exported vlog carries a big title for the first three seconds and captions of the narration, a few words at a time, with the word being spoken highlighted. These are drawn into the video pixels, so they become what users post. Please design them as a small set of presets with exact specs.



TikTok, Reels and Shorts cover the top bar, the bottom fifth and a column on the right with their own buttons. Today the title is centred at 15% of the frame height and the captions at 70%, both within 84% of the width. Keep your presets inside those zones.

ELEMENT	NOW	NOTES
Title	10% of width	Wraps up to 3 lines, fades in 0.25 s, out 0.35 s, shows 0–3 s
Captions	7.2% of width	Up to 4 words / 22 characters per chunk, current word highlighted
Extra label	5% of width	Optional per scene (a place name, a price)
Legibility	Dark outline	Must read on any footage: bright sky, snow, night

Current caption presets

Rename, replace or add. Each preset needs: font family and weight, title and caption case, text colour, highlight colour, outline or box colour, and corner radius if boxed.

PRESET	WEIGHT	CASE	TEXT	HIGHLIGHT	LEGIBILITY
Classic	800	Title caps	☐ #FFFFFF	☒ #FFD84D	Black outline, 85%
Bold	900	All caps	☐ #FFFFFF	☒ #4DFF9A	Black outline, 95%
Minimal	600	Sentence	☐ #FFFFFF	None	Soft outline, 45%

PRESET	WEIGHT	CASE	TEXT	HIGHLIGHT	LEGIBILITY
Box	800	Title caps	■ #111111	■ #E0218A	White box behind each line

Also in the video: crossfade, dip-to-black and whip transitions (0.35 s), and three formats: 1080×1920 vertical, 1080×1080 square, 1920×1080 wide. If you want an end card or a watermark for a free plan, design it as an optional overlay.

● DESIGN TOKENS

Swap these, and the whole app changes

All app colours, radii and the font come from one file, `src/index.css`. The values below are placeholders. Give us yours by role and we drop them in. Add tokens if your system needs more (for example a second surface or a brand gradient).

TOKEN	ROLE	LIGHT NOW	DARK NOW
--color-bg	Page background	□ #FFFFFF	■ #0B0D12
--color-surface	Soft fills, tabs, info boxes	□ #F6F7F9	■ #151821
--color-surface-2	Secondary buttons, placeholders	□ #ECEE2	■ #1E222D
--color-border	Card and input borders	□ #E2E5EA	■ #2A2F3C
--color-fg	Main text	■ #0B0D12	□ #F3F4F6
--color-muted	Secondary text	■ #5F6673	■ #9AA1AE
--color-accent	Brand / primary actions, selection	■ #2563EB	■ #4F86FF
--color-accent-fg	Text on accent	□ #FFFFFF	□ #FFFFFF
--color-accent-soft	Selected chip / card fill	□ #E8EFF	■ #1A2747
--color-danger	Errors, recording, delete	■ #DC2626	same
--color-success	Done, recorded	■ #16A34A	same
--color-warning	Star (must include), clip warnings	■ #D97706	same
--radius-card	Cards, sheets, preview	16px	—

TOKEN	ROLE	LIGHT NOW	DARK NOW
--radius-control	Buttons, inputs	12px	—
--font-sans	All UI text	Inter → system	—

● COMPONENTS

What the app is built from

These exist in code today. Design each with its states (default, hover, pressed, focus, disabled, loading where it applies).

COMPONENT	VARIANTS / STATES	USED ON
Button	Primary, secondary, ghost, danger · sm / md / lg · icon + label · loading	Everywhere
Chip	Selected / not · horizontally scrolling group with label	Script settings, voice switch
Text input, auto-growing text area	Placeholder, focus, disabled, with label + hint	Script, sign-in, scene sheet
Step bar	Done / current / not reached	All project screens
Sticky footer	One or two actions + optional hint line	Every step
Clip tile	Importing, ready, error, starred, similar · duration badge · remove	Clips
Script line row	Drag handle, text, remove · dragging	Script
Option card (radio)	Selected / not, icon, title, body	Voice mode
Voice card	Selected, preview idle / loading / playing	Voice
Record row + teleprompter	Not recorded / recorded · idle / recording / saving · level meter	Voice
Stage list + progress bar	Waiting, active (with detail), done, failed	Make
Video player	Paused, playing, ended, “mixing audio” · scrub bar, time	Edit

COMPONENT	VARIANTS / STATES	USED ON
Scene card	Active (playing now), number, length, shot count, line text	Edit
Bottom sheet	Title, close, scrolling body · centred dialog on desktop	Scene, export, teleprompter, sign-in
Segmented tabs	Scenes / Voice / Music / Style	Edit
Slider	Labelled volume slider, trim range	Edit panels, trim
Toast	Info, error	Everywhere
Badge	“Demo AI”, “Similar”, duration	Home, clips

● COPY

Voice and messages

Tone: friendly, short, plain. Talk about clips, lines, scenes and voices, never “assets”, “tracks” or “renders”. Feel free to rewrite any of this; here are the messages that exist today so none get missed.

WHERE	MESSAGE
Home	“Your clips, made into a vlog.” · “Your videos stay on this device.”
Clips	“Pick the videos from your day. Messy is fine: we’ll find the best moments and skip the accidental ones.”
Clip error	“This browser can’t decode HEVC video. Try the latest Chrome or Safari.” · “Couldn’t read this video.”
Limits	“You can add up to 30 clips” · “total footage is over 10 minutes” · “total size is over 4 GB”
Script	Placeholders: “I woke up early and grabbed coffee.”, “Then I biked through the park.” · Confirm: “Replace your lines with a new AI script?”
Voice	“Microphone access is needed to record. Check your browser settings.” · “Couldn’t save that take. Try again.”
Make error	“6 lines are not recorded yet. Go back to Voice to record them.” · “None of your clips could be read. Add a few more clips and try again.”

WHERE	MESSAGE
Edit	“Made a simple edit because the AI editor wasn’t available.” · “A vlog needs at least one scene.”
Limits (live)	“You’ve used your free vlog. Sign in to make more.” · “You’ve made 10 vlogs today, the daily limit. Try again tomorrow.”
Export	“Rendering... 42%. Keep this tab open.” · “This browser can’t encode video. Try the latest Chrome or Safari.”

● RULES & CONSTRAINTS

Things the build needs from the design

- **Fonts must be web fonts we can bundle** (Google Fonts or a licence that allows web and video embedding). Caption fonts are drawn into exported videos, so check the licence covers that.
- **Touch targets at least 44×44 px.** Primary actions sit in the bottom footer, within thumb reach.
- **Respect the phone’s safe areas** (notch, home bar). The header and footer already pad for them.
- **Contrast:** WCAG AA for text in both themes. Focus states must be visible for keyboard users.
- **Motion:** keep it short and purposeful; provide a reduced-motion fallback for anything that moves.
- **Icons:** the build uses Lucide line icons. Another set is fine if it covers: play, pause, mic, star, scissors, swap, music, palette, film, send, undo, redo, share, download.
- **No timeline UI**, by product decision.
- **Out of scope for now:** marketing site, pricing pages, photos as input, templates, multiple languages, collaboration. Leave room for a future “Templates” entry point on Script and an “Upgrade” spot on Home and Export.

Screenshots captured from the working prototype on 8 Oct 2026 at 390×844 (2×) and 1280×860. The colour-bar videos are generated test clips. Source and screenshots live in the repository under [docs/design-handoff/](#).